

VELUSE AGENCY STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE (SOP) DEPARTMENT:

Executive Operations & Human Resources **SUBJECT:** The Talent & Leadership

Protocol PURPOSE: To establish Veluse Agency's operational mandate for recruiting, managing, and scaling elite talent. A business's growth is permanently capped by the aggregate intelligence and skill of the people within it. We must systematically acquire "Champions" and build an infrastructure that maximizes their leverage.

PART 1: "THE LEADER IS ALWAYS THE PROBLEM" RULE

If there is ever a problem in a department, an organization, or a revenue line at Veluse Agency or within our Med Spa clients' businesses, you must look directly at the leader 1.

The Rule: The leader is *always* the problem. Not sometimes; always 1.

- If a function is mediocre, it is because the leader is mediocre, period 1.
- If a leader is mediocre but inherits a great team, that leader will actively turn the great team into a mediocre team 1.

Operational Directive: Never try to solve tactical business problems (like pricing or sales scripts) if the leader of that department is compromised or incompetent 2. Tactical advice is useless because a mediocre leader commands no respect and cannot enforce execution 2, 3. You must remove or fix the leader before you attempt to fix the underlying business metrics 3.

PART 2: THE RECRUITING PROTOCOL (FINDING "CHAMPIONS")

To build a \$100M infrastructure, we do not want people who need to be taught how to run. We are looking for Champions—people who have already run an Olympic gold and want to run another one with us 4.

1. The "Barbell" Hiring Strategy When scaling teams, avoid the "middle" careerists who just want a title bump to pad their resume 5, 6. Target the two extremes of the barbell:

- **The Hungry Youth:** Hire extremely young talent with a chip on their shoulder who are desperate to work all the time to learn 5, 6.
- **The Veterans:** Hire people out of retirement or at the absolute end of their careers. They do not care about titles; they want to contribute, be useful, and leave a legacy 5, 6.

2. The Metrics Litmus Test You can determine a candidate's true skill level by the quantity and quality of the metrics they use to describe their past roles 7-9. If you ask a candidate how they make the company money, and they respond with vague concepts instead of hard numbers, they are not a Champion 10-12. An elite hire will track detailed KPIs (e.g., "Time to fill," "Two-way 90-day fit," or "Cost to acquire talent") that you likely do not even know exist 8, 13, 14.

3. Raise the Average Bar Every single time you hire someone, you must ask: *"Does this person raise the average bar of the team they are joining?"* 15-17. If you hire a "six" to join a team of "eights," they will pull the entire team down 18, 19. If the candidate does not objectively raise the average talent level of the department, do not hire them 17. Your best talent is always in the future 17, 20.

PART 3: THE TALENT GRID & INCENTIVIZING TALENT

To scale Veluse Agency, we must accurately grade our talent and our departments to identify bottlenecks. We utilize the "Talent Grid," which categorizes talent into three evolutionary levels:

- **Level 1: Doing (Individual Contributor).** The employee is focused on *what* to do. They spend 100% of their time executing the work themselves 21, 22.
- **Level 2: Teaching (Manager).** The employee understands *how* the work is done and teaches others to replicate the skill. They ensure the team executes consistently 23, 24.
- **Level 3: Leading (Systematizer).** The leader focuses on *who*. They do not do the work or teach the work; they build the machine that builds the machine 24, 25.

Incentivizing Talent (Unlocking Discretionary Effort): Money attracts talent, but culture keeps them 26. However, traditional corporate structures force elite "Level 1" technicians to become "Level 2" managers just to earn more money 27, 28. This is a fatal flaw.

- **Dual Tracks:** Create separate career tracks for elite individual contributors (technical) and managers, ensuring both have uncapped earning potential 27, 28.
- **Pay for Performance:** To unlock "discretionary effort"—the massive gap between doing enough to not get fired and doing one's absolute best—tie compensation directly to output 29-31.
- **The Transition:** When shifting existing employees to pay-for-performance, let them keep their current base salary and add the performance bonuses on top 32. This creates rapid adoption and zero resentment 32.

PART 4: MAKER VS. MANAGER (THE EXECUTIVE ASSISTANT MANDATE)

To ensure the visionary founders and executives at Veluse Agency are not consumed by low-leverage tasks, we must rigorously protect their time using the Maker vs. Manager concept.

The Paradigm:

- **Managers** operate their day in 30-to-60-minute time blocks. For a manager, a fully booked calendar of meetings is a perfectly productive day 33, 34.
- **Makers** (builders, coders, copywriters, and founders) require massive, half-day or full-day uninterrupted blocks of time to create value 33, 35. A single 30-minute meeting inserted into a Maker's afternoon destroys their productivity because it costs them a massive "work unit" and shatters their deep flow 36-38.

The Executive Assistant (EA) Hiring & Execution Protocol:

1. **Pay for Speed and Intellect:** When hiring an EA, pay more than you expect. Look for high general intelligence, and establish that absolute speed is non-negotiable 1, 39, 40.
2. **The Maker vs. Manager Training:** During onboarding, force the EA to watch the Maker vs. Manager video. They must possess a deep contextual understanding of how the executive's life and productivity function 1.
3. **Calendar Defense:** The EA is the ultimate gatekeeper. They must consolidate all necessary "Manager" meetings to the very back of the day (e.g., booking backward from 5:00 PM to 3:00 PM) to preserve massive, unbroken "Maker" blocks in the morning 41, 42.

4. **Loop Management:** The EA must manage all ongoing project loops, follow-ups, and deadlines. The executive's calendar should appear entirely empty, relieving mental drag and allowing them to focus purely on high-leverage execution 40, 43.